

Welcome home!

When you start up your computer, you will likely see a boot-up screen asking you if you wish to choose Windows or Ubuntu (that is, if you installed Ubuntu alongside Windows). Choose Ubuntu from the list using the cursor keys (the up/down arrow keys) and hit enter and it will start up Ubuntu.

The next screen you will see is the Ubuntu login screen. It's the screen you will see every time you start up Ubuntu. If prompted, select the username that you created earlier (or type it in if required), then enter your password. The system will then log you on.

The Ubuntu Desktop

The Ubuntu desktop is a friendly place, which we will cover in the chapters [six \(How do I use Linux?\)](#) and [seven \(Using Linux Every Day\)](#). If you are used to Windows, your 'Start' menu is the bar along the left hand side. The bottom button which looks like a bunch of dots allows you to search your computer for Apps. Simply by start typing the app's name (eg Firefox) or simply by looking at the list of icons for all of your apps.

Favorite Apps

You'll note that a few favourite Apps have already been 'pinned' to the bar on the left, these include the Firefox web browser, the LibreOffice (free Microsoft Office compatible word, excel, powerpoint suite). You can pin your own favourites to the left-hand side bar if you desire simply by dragging an icon from the Applications list into the bar.

Where are all my files?

On the left-hand side bar there's a folder icon. Clicking on this will show you all the files on your computer. In most cases, your Ubuntu machine will have been set up to see your Windows file systems by default. Clicking on the folder icon, you'll see 'Other Locations'. In here, you can see your Windows drive. Illustrated in the below screenshot.